The subsequent investigation was an attempt by the authorities to conceal the facts of the incidents. The report's findings were published in *Working People's Daily* in mid May. The number of casualties was grossly underscored. The type of ammunition used by the security forces was covered up (the claim that automatic weapons were not used proved to be false). Finally, the police claimed that outside agitators caused much of the disruption.

Protests continued into the summer with some estimates stating that over one million people in Rangoon took part at some point in time. Than Shwe, the deputy chief of staff, was mortified and secured his family in a compound with additional security forces present. Adding more fuel to the fire, rumors throughout the country stated the United States had moved naval ships into the waters off the coast. Fear of a possible international invasion gained momentum. In reality, this was totally untrue and Western nations never made any sort of movement toward Myanmar or ever contemplated such a policy shift.

Criticism of the regime continued to mount. Retired Brigadier General Aung Gyi released a scathing indictment of the handling of the situation. Gyi had also criticized Ne Win's failed economic policies. The general encouraged Ne Win to distance himself from the military hardliners who were responsible for the mishandling of the protests. With such a long-time regime supporter abandoning the regime and openly criticizing policy, it was becoming apparent that change was in the air.

SUMMER OF HOPE: 1988

Protests reignited in Burma following the opening of the universities in late May. By late June, student's demands included the rebuilding of the Rangoon Student Union, as well as more autonomy within the educational bureaucracy. The regime once again closed down the RASU. Protests persisted as the government sent in the Lon Htein to quell the disturbances. The students fended off the riot police by fleeing into alley and backstreet market areas. Protesters fought back and inflicted casualties not seen during the White Bridge massacre in March. Twenty officers were killed in the melee.